FREE SAMPLE · October 21, 2026

Physics PhD Atlas 2027

10 of 40 programs from the full Atlas for international physics applicants (US, Canada and Europe), with every value copied from the program's own official page.

Six things international physics applicants miss this cycle

1. **The Physics GRE is back at some top programs.** In the full Atlas, it's required this cycle at Caltech, Cornell (theory applicants), Stanford, Calgary (international applicants), Berkeley, UChicago.
2. **Some fees are free right now.** Penn State waives its fee for everyone with code PHYS2027. Rice runs a worldwide fee-waiver window until Nov 1, 2026.
3. **"My degree was in English" isn't always enough.** Waterloo rejects medium-of-instruction letters. Alberta's exemption list includes the IITs and IISc but not the IISERs. UT Austin exempts applicants from India outright.
4. **TOEFL changed scales on Jan 21, 2026.** Programs now list two minimums (e.g., UBC: 90 old scale / 4.5 new scale).
5. **Canada often admits supervisor-first.** Waterloo requires a supervisor match, Ottawa wants a supervisor's name at application, and Calgary admits only if a supervisor will fund you.
6. **Europe runs on different rules.** EPFL charges no application fee; Cambridge charges £20 per year for up to 7 doctoral applications; Heidelberg's physics graduate-school portal closes Nov 1; at ETH Zurich and Leiden you apply to a professor or an advertised paid position instead of a central committee.

Sample: 10 programs

Program	Deadline	Fee	Fee waiver (internationals)	Physics GRE	English-test waiver	Supervisor first?
EPFL Switzerland	Apr 30, 2027	0 (no fee)	Not needed: no application fee	Not stated	No English test is strictly required; proficiency in English is required and TOEFL is strongly recommended	Required

Penn State USA	Jan 15, 2027	0 (waived)	Automatic for everyone this cycle via code PHYS2027 (international included)	Not stated	Rule is country-based ('non-English speaking countries'); exemption list not shown on the page checked	Not stated
Rice USA	Dec 15, 2026	85 USD	Doctoral Fee Waiver Weeks open to students worldwide Oct 14-Nov 1, 2026 (or until waivers run out); completed application due Nov 27. Also waived for Texas/neighbouring-state students, GCURS speakers, Fulbright Scholars.	Not considered	Exemption rules not shown on the department page checked	Not stated
Stanford USA	Dec 14, 2026	Not stated	Some applicants may qualify; see Stanford Graduate Admissions fee-waiver page for eligibility	Required	Not required if your degree (or international equivalent) is from a university where ALL instruction was in English; no documents needed at application	Not stated
Alberta Canada	Dec 01, 2026	Not stated	Department says the fee cannot be waived	Not stated	Exempt only if your country or institution is on the FGPS recognized list. For India it lists e.g. IITs (all campuses), IISc, University of Hyderabad, Jadavpur, NIT Calicut; IISERs are NOT listed. Physics will not waive otherwise.	Not stated

UBC Canada	Dec 01, 2026	168.25 CAD	Automatic waiver only for citizens AND residents of the UN's 50 least developed countries (India is not on that list)	Not required	Test required only if your university's primary language of instruction is not English (confirm with the program for your institution)	Not required
Cambridge United Kingdom	Dec 08, 2026	20 GBP	A waiver exists for eligible applicants; eligibility criteria not shown on the page checked	Not stated	Exemption needs nationality of, or a degree from, a 'majority English-speaking country' (UKVI list); India is not on that list	Recommended
UT Austin USA	Dec 01, 2026	90 USD	Graduate School waivers for applicants meeting certain criteria; department not involved. Check criteria for international eligibility.	Optional	India is on UT's list of qualifying countries exempt from TOEFL/IELTS (also exempt with a bachelor's from a U.S./qualifying-country institution)	Not stated
Toronto Canada	Dec 11, 2026	135 CAD	Fee cannot be waived under any circumstances	Not required	No test if your degree is from a university where instruction AND examination are in English; an official letter is needed unless the transcript says so	Not required

Waterloo Canada	Jan 09, 2027	150 CAD	No fee-waiver route stated on the pages checked	Recommended	Exempt only if 3+ years of study at a university listed in WHED with English as the ONLY language of instruction; exemption expires 2 years after graduation; medium-of-instruction letters are not accepted	Required

Deadline years are inferred where a page gives only a day and month. Confirm every value on the official page before paying or submitting.

The full kit

- **Offline explorer** for all 40 programs: filter by Physics GRE, English waiver, fee waivers and supervisor rules, and tap any value to see the official quote.
- **Planner workbook**: auto-filling shortlist, deadline countdown, fee budget, recommender and supervisor-outreach trackers.
- **Playbook**: timeline, English-test rules, GRE decisions, Canadian supervisor emails, physics SOP framework, letter kit, ethical fee-waiver requests.
- Free updates for the Fall 2027 cycle. 14-day refund.

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